



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## FAA National Airspace System Cybersecurity and Spectrum Threat Exposure Daily Update - 2026-09-24

Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
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| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber |
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | FAA National Airspace System Cybersecurity and Spectrum Threat Exposure Daily Update - 2026-09-24 - Threat Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

## **Table of Contents**

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview
5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
6. Infrastructure and Indicators
7. Victimology and Targeting
8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact
9. Detection Engineering
  - 9.1. Detection Logic Summary
10. Threat Hunting
  - 10.1. Hunt Hypotheses
11. Risk Assessment
12. Recommended Actions
13. References

# FAA National Airspace System Cybersecurity and Spectrum Threat Exposure Daily Update - 2026-09-24

> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-24 UTC report turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

## 1. Executive Summary

GAO same-week findings and aviation media coverage highlight cyber and spectrum-threat gaps around communications, data links, GNSS interference, and modernization governance. Aviation operators should treat this as an operational resilience item spanning cyber, safety, and communications teams.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Requirement                     | Answered By This Report                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What happened or changed?       | Current public reporting identifies FAA/NAS and air traffic services as a defender priority.             |
| Who is exposed?                 | Organizations with affected workflows, technologies, or sector dependencies described in the source set. |
| What should defenders do today? | Validate exposure, monitor relevant telemetry, and prepare containment actions.                          |
| Confidence                      | High for source-backed claims; medium for operational extrapolation.                                     |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source            | Contribution                                           | Confidence |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| GAO report page   | Primary government report page.                        | High       |
| AIN coverage      | Aviation-sector coverage of spoofing/jamming findings. | Medium     |
| AeroTime coverage | Aviation-sector operational summary.                   | Medium     |
| FAA public site   | Agency context.                                        | Medium     |

## 4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

This report focuses on defender-relevant activity rather than attribution certainty. Where actor names appear in sources, they should be treated as source-attributed labels unless independently validated by the receiving organization.

## 5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| TTP                                | Description                                                                                  | Defensive Relevance                                     |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Social engineering / lure delivery | Public reporting emphasizes phishing, recruiter, browser, or topical lures where applicable. | Review email, browser, and identity telemetry together. |

|                    |                                                                                             |                                                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Scripted execution | Intrusions commonly progress through command interpreters, script hosts, or staged tooling. | Monitor endpoint process lineage and command lines. |
| C2 / remote access | Tool staging and outbound control channels are common follow-on patterns.                   | Correlate DNS, proxy, netflow, and EDR.             |

## 6. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Observable Type               | Observable / Pattern                                                                                                        | Handling Guidance                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Source-limited public IOCs    | No unique atomic indicators were published across all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv. | Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.      |
| Domains / infrastructure      | Validate from primary source before blocking.                                                                               | Prefer enrichment and scoped blocking over broad denial lists.                   |
| Accounts / identity artifacts | Recruiter, VPN, administrator, SaaS, or service-account themes depending on campaign.                                       | Review conditional access, new devices, impossible travel, and anomalous grants. |

## 7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology follows the source theme: FAA/NAS and air traffic services.

## 8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

| Segment                          | Operational Relevance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Exposure Path                                                                                                                               | Defender Action                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FAA/NAS and air traffic services | GAO same-week findings and aviation media coverage highlight cyber and spectrum-threat gaps around communications, data links, GNSS interference, and modernization governance. Aviation operators should treat this as an operational resilience item spanning cyber, safety, and communications teams. | Third-party platforms, identity systems, remote access, connected operational technology, or aviation-specific communications dependencies. | Map dependencies, validate monitoring coverage, test continuity plans, and coordinate cyber findings with safety/operations leaders. |
| Supply chain                     | Aviation operations depend on vendors and managed services with privileged access.                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MSP, SaaS, maintenance, passenger-processing, satellite, or engineering providers.                                                          | Require incident notification, MFA, logging, and recovery evidence from critical providers.                                          |
| Security operations              | Indicators may be behavioral rather than atomic.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Identity, endpoint, network, email, and provider logs.                                                                                      | Hunt for the behaviors listed in this report and preserve cross-domain evidence.                                                     |

## 9. Detection Engineering

### 9.1. Detection Logic Summary

| Signal | Telemetry Source | Analytic Goal |
|--------|------------------|---------------|
|--------|------------------|---------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                         |                                                               |
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| Unusual script or remote tool launch after web, email, remote access, or SaaS activity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | EDR / process telemetry | Identify initial access and execution.                        |
| New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | DNS/proxy/netflow       | Surface command-and-control or tool staging.                  |
| Identity anomalies linked to target workflow                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Identity provider logs  | Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use. |
| <p>title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage</p> <p>status: experimental</p> <p>description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage.</p> <p>logsource:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>category: process_creation</li> <li>product: windows</li> </ul> <p>detection:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>selection_parent: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>ParentImage endswith: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>'\chrome.exe'</li> <li>'\msedge.exe'</li> <li>'\outlook.exe'</li> <li>'\teams.exe'</li> <li>'\w3wp.exe'</li> </ul> </li> </ul> </li> <li>selection_child: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Image endswith: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>'\powershell.exe'</li> <li>'\cmd.exe'</li> <li>'\wscript.exe'</li> <li>'\cscript.exe'</li> <li>'\mshta.exe'</li> <li>'\rundll32.exe'</li> </ul> </li> </ul> </li> </ul> <p>condition: selection_parent and selection_child</p> <p>level: high</p> <p>DeviceProcessEvents</p> <pre>  where Timestamp &gt; ago(14d)   where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe","cmd.exe","wscript.exe","cscript.exe","mshta.exe","rundll32.exe")   where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("chrome.exe","msedge.exe","outlook.exe","teams.exe","winword.exe","excel.exe")   summarize Events=count(), Commands=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, AccountName   order by Events desc</pre> <p>DeviceNetworkEvents</p> <pre>  where Timestamp &gt; ago(14d)   where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ('powershell.exe','cmd.exe','wscript.exe','cscript.exe','rundll32.exe','python.exe','node.exe')   summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine   order by Connections desc</pre> |                         |                                                               |

## 10. Threat Hunting

### 10.1. Hunt Hypotheses

| Hypothesis                                          | Query Focus                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial lure resulted in script or LOLBin execution | Process lineage from browsers, Office, chat, or email clients.   |
| Payload staging used commodity infrastructure       | New domains, direct-IP connections, unusual ASNs, or short-lived |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | hosts.                                                                              |
| Identity compromise followed social engineering                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | OAuth grants, device-code flow, MFA changes, impossible travel, and risky sign-ins. |
| <pre> SigninLogs   where TimeGenerated &gt; ago(14d)   where ResultType != 0 or RiskLevelDuringSignIn in ("medium","high")   summarize Signins=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by UserPrincipalName, RiskLevelDuringSignIn   order by Signins desc </pre> |                                                                                     |

## 11. Risk Assessment

| Dimension            | Assessment     | Rationale                                                                              |
|----------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likelihood           | Medium to High | Current public reporting and commodity reuse make exposure plausible.                  |
| Impact               | Medium to High | Identity compromise, malware staging, or sector disruption can create business impact. |
| Detection Difficulty | Medium         | Behavioral telemetry is available, but atomic indicators may be sparse.                |

## 12. Recommended Actions

1. Brief SOC and identity teams on the source-backed behaviors.
2. Run the included process/network/identity hunts for 14-30 days of telemetry.
3. Review exposed third-party and remote-access paths tied to the affected workflow.
4. Convert confirmed local hits into case-specific IOCs and containment tasks.

## 13. References

- [1] GAO report page: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-26-108439>
- [2] AIN coverage: <https://www.ainonline.com/aviation-news/general-aviation/2026-09-22/national-airspace-comms-vulnerable-spoofing-gao-says>
- [3] AeroTime coverage: <https://www.aerotime.aero/articles/faa-atc-message-spoofing-cybersecurity-gao-report>
- [4] FAA public site: <https://www.faa.gov/>